Switching Models in OpenClaw

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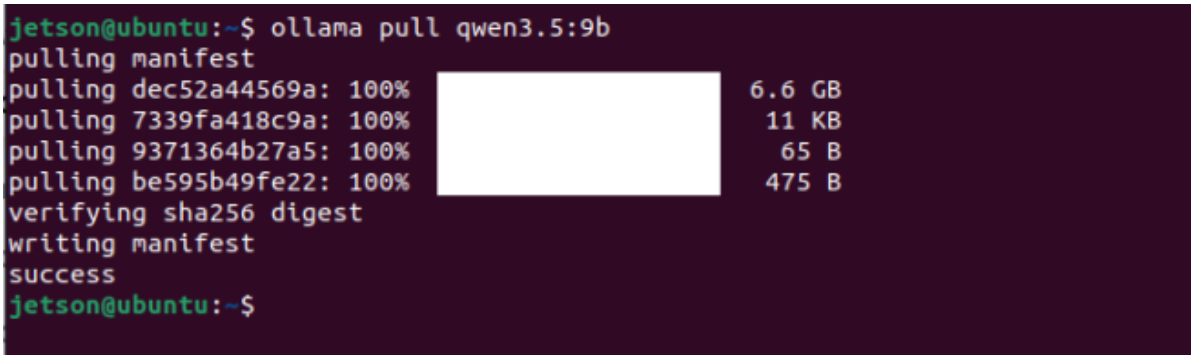
Sometimes it's necessary to switch to different models to test performance and functionality. The following demonstrates how to switch local models using Ollama.

1. Download the Model

Open the terminal and enter the following command to download the model you want to test. Here, we take ollama downloading qwen3.5:9b as an example:

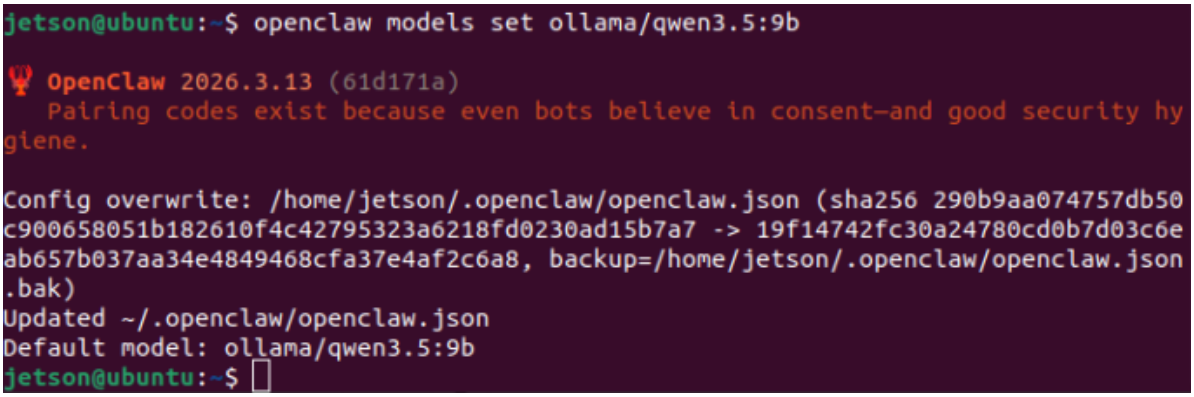
```
ollama pull qwen3.5:9b
```



2. Set the Default Model

Run the command to set the default model:

```
openclaw models set ollama/qwen3.5:9b
```



3. Restart the OpenClaw Gateway

First, stop the gateway:

```
openclaw gateway Stop
```

Restart the gateway

```
OpenClaw gateway restart
```

```
jetson@ubuntu:~$ openclaw gateway stop

🦞 OpenClaw 2026.3.13 (61d171a)
   Gateway online—please keep hands, feet, and appendages inside the shell at al
l times.

Stopped systemd service: openclaw-gateway.service
jetson@ubuntu:~$ openclaw gateway restart

🦞 OpenClaw 2026.3.13 (61d171a)
   I can grep it, git blame it, and gently roast it—pick your coping mechanism.

Restarted systemd service: openclaw-gateway.service
```

4. Check Default Model Configuration

Check the default model settings for OpenClaw. If you see "ollama/qwen3.5:9b" displayed under "Default," the setting is successful.

```
OpenClaw models status
```

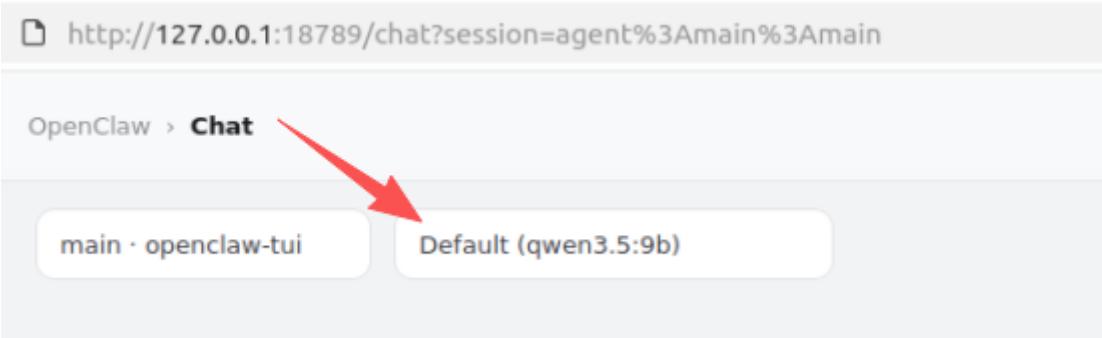
```
jetson@ubuntu:~$ openclaw models status

🦞 OpenClaw 2026.3.13 (61d171a) — You had me at 'openclaw gateway start.'

Config          : ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Agent dir       : ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
Default         : ollama/qwen3.5:9b
Fallbacks (0) : -
Image model     : -
Image fallbacks (0): -
Aliases (0)     : -
Configured models (3): ollama/glm-4.7-flash, ollama/qwen3.5:9b, ollama/glm-4.7-f
lash:latest
```

5. Check Individual Plugin Model Configuration

Generally, if a default model is set, it will be automatically used during interaction. However, sometimes if a plugin model is specified in WebChat, it will not automatically switch to the default model. In this case, you need to manually change the model to the default model.

First, open WebChat.

```
openclaw dashboard
```


http://127.0.0.1:18789/chat?session=agent%3Amain%3Amain
OpenClaw › Chat
main · openclaw-tui
Default (qwen3.5:9b)